Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9–1)

Wednesday 15 May 2026
Morning (Time: 1 hour 20 minutes)

PAPER REFERENCE
1HI0/11

History

PAPER 1: Thematic study and historic environment

Option 11: Medicine in Britain, c1250–present and The British sector of the Western Front, 1914–18: injuries, treatment and the trenches

Sources Booklet

Do not return this Booklet with the question paper.

Sources for use with Section A.

This booklet contains Source A and Source B for use with Question 2 on the question paper.

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Sources for use with Section A.

Source A: From the journal of Reverend Arthur Davies, July 1916. He was serving as an army chaplain at a Casualty Clearing Station near the Somme. He is describing the opening days of the offensive.

1 July 1916 The casualties have started to arrive. Throughout the day, the injured and dying are brought in continuously. The volume of patients is overwhelming; every bed is occupied, and men are fortunate just to find a spot on the bare ground. Many will pass away before surgery is possible. We have already admitted 1,500 casualties, and the stream has not stopped. 3 July 1916 Another thousand severely injured men arrive daily. The wards, tents, and wooden huts are packed to the limit with suffering soldiers.

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Sources for use with Section A (continued).

Source B: From a letter written by Edith Smith, a VAD nurse, to her sister in December 1917. She was stationed at a base hospital near the French coast.

Our morning duties (changing the linens, washing patients, recording temperatures, and dispensing medication) begin at 3.30 am! The freezing temperatures are unbearable. Icicles hang thick over the ward windows. I have to work while wearing an extra knitted sweater and my heavy overcoat. Even the kettles, rubber hot water bottles, and washing sponges have frozen solid. The pipes freeze entirely, meaning we must strictly ration the water provided to the wounded. If any water splashes onto the floor, it instantly turns into a sheet of ice.

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